

Amara

gives piano lesson 100

wants vegetable box 120

on Amara's scale

$$60/100 = 0.60$$

Bruno

gives vegetable box 50

wants piano lesson 60

on Bruno's scale

$$120/50 = 2.40$$

Each rate is the taker's bid over the giver's ask,
in mixed units. Around the loop the units cancel:

$$\prod_{\text{rate}} = \prod_i \frac{\text{bid}_i}{\text{ask}_i} = \frac{120}{100} \cdot \frac{60}{50} = 1.44$$

Nothing is held or transferred on either scale.